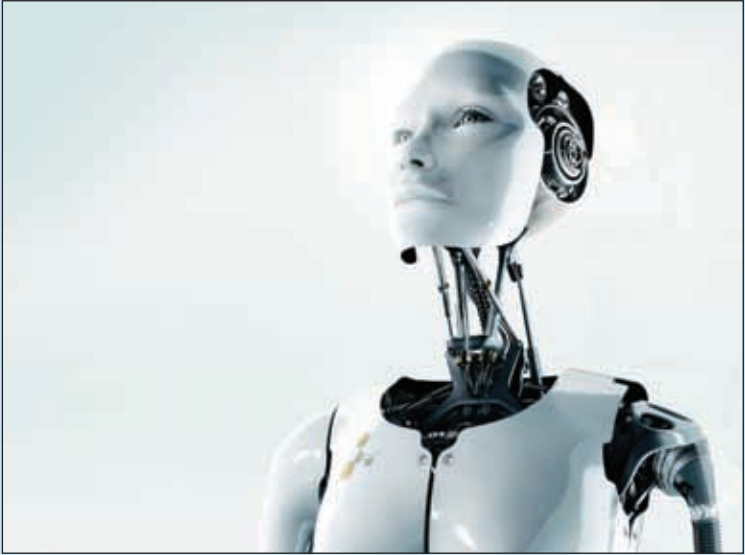




FICTIONAL AI

The most important visions of artificial intelligence in science fiction and some of the science behind them

The coming of age of computers and the possibility of artificial intelligence was the kind of stuff every writer dreams of. Here was unexplored territory grounded in reality. It was in 1956 that John McCarthy first coined the term “artificial intelligence” and in the next few years, a slew of science-fiction writers took it to its extreme possibilities.

Any discussion about artificial intelligence in science fiction usually ends up in a debate between who was the better writer: Isaac Asimov or Arthur C. Clarke. Both authors have written innumerable pieces on AI that far surpass any of their peers – those born then and those still to